Exercise 1 : SQL Fundamentals 21 September 2026

SELECT & Filtering

Selecting and sorting:

1) SELECT id,
first_name,
last_name,
department,
salary,
hire_date,
city
From employees;

| id | first_name | last_name | department | Salary | hire_date | city |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Alice | Green | IT | 70000 | 2020/01/10 | Johannesburg |
| 2 | Brian | Lee | HR | 45000 | 2019/03/22 | Cape Town |
| 3 | Cathy | Zulu | Finance | 65000 | 2018/07/15 | Durban |
| 4 | David | Makoena | Marketing | 50000 | 2021/11/05 | Pretoria |
| 5 | Eva | Naidoo | IT | 72000 | 2017/09/30 | Johannesburg |

2) SELECT department,
DISTINCT (department)
From employees;

| department |
|---|
| HR |
| Finance |
| Marketing |

3) SELECT first_names,
last_names
~~COUNT DESC ORDER BY (salary) DESC~~
From employees
ORDER BY salary DESC;

| first_name | last_name | Salary |
|---|---|---|
| Eva | Naidoo | 72000 |
| Alice | Green | 70000 |
| Cathy | Zulu | 65000 |
| David | Makoena | 50000 |
| Brian | Lee | 45000 |

4) SELECT id,
first_name,
last_name,
salary

| id | first_name | last_name | Salary |
|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Eva | Naidoo | 72000 |
| ~~1~~ 1 | Alice | Green | 70000 |
| ~~3~~ 3 | Cathy | Zulu | 65000 |